

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

BCA Semester 1 • Complete Colour Notes

Syllabus-aligned study material covering Modules I–V with explanations, examples, diagrams, exam questions and practical formats.

MODULE I Essential English Grammar	MODULE II Written English Communication
MODULE III Concept & Nature of Communication	MODULE IV Effective Presentation
MODULE V Employment Communication	EXAM KIT Questions • Formats • Revision

Note: Original study notes prepared from the supplied syllabus; not a reproduction of the referenced textbooks.

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Module II — Written English Communication

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Exam Kit — Important questions and revision

MODULE I — ESSENTIAL ENGLISH GRAMMAR

Goal: Build accuracy and confidence in formal English used in academic and professional communication.

1. Tenses

Tense shows the time of an action or state. Present, past and future can be expressed through simple, continuous, perfect and perfect continuous forms.

Example: Check the subject first, then choose the correct verb; read the sentence aloud to catch awkward structure.

2. Subject–Verb Agreement

A verb should agree with its subject in number and person. Ignore intervening phrases when identifying the true subject.

Example: Check the subject first, then choose the correct verb; read the sentence aloud to catch awkward structure.

3. Punctuation

Punctuation organizes meaning. Common marks include full stop, comma, semicolon, colon, question mark, exclamation mark, quotation marks and apostrophe.

Example: Check the subject first, then choose the correct verb; read the sentence aloud to catch awkward structure.

4. Sentence Structure

A sentence normally contains a subject and predicate. Common patterns include Subject + Verb, Subject + Verb + Object and Subject + Linking Verb + Complement.

Example: Check the subject first, then choose the correct verb; read the sentence aloud to catch awkward structure.

5. Common Errors in English

Frequent errors include wrong tense, article misuse, subject–verb mismatch, confusing homophones, faulty prepositions, double negatives and fragments.

Example: Check the subject first, then choose the correct verb; read the sentence aloud to catch awkward structure.

6. Foreign Words

English contains many borrowed words. Use uncommon foreign terms only when they add precision, and explain them when the audience may not know them.

Example: Check the subject first, then choose the correct verb; read the sentence aloud to catch awkward structure.

Grammar Flow

Idea	Subject	Verb	Object	Punctuation	Review
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Q. What is subject–verb agreement?

Answer: The rule that a verb form should match its subject in number and person.

Q. Why is punctuation important?

Answer: It separates ideas, shows relationships and reduces ambiguity.

MODULE II — WRITTEN ENGLISH COMMUNICATION

Writing should be clear, concise, coherent and audience-focused. Identify purpose, reader, tone and format before drafting.

Essay Writing

Structure: Introduction → Body paragraphs → Conclusion. The introduction presents the central idea; body paragraphs develop it with reasons and examples; the conclusion synthesizes the discussion.

Plan	Introduction	Body	Evidence	Conclusion	Edit
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Writing Tips

- Create a short outline.
- Keep one main idea per paragraph.
- Use logical transitions.
- Avoid repetition and slang in formal writing.
- Edit grammar, spelling, logic and punctuation.

Precis Writing

A precis is a concise version of a longer passage that preserves its central meaning. Identify essential points, remove repetition and write in your own words.

Summarising

A summary presents the essential points of a source without unnecessary detail. It should be accurate, concise and neutral.

Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing restates an idea in your own wording and sentence structure while preserving meaning. It is more than replacing a few words with synonyms.

Q. Difference between summary and paraphrase?

Answer: A summary reduces a text to its main points; a paraphrase restates a particular idea or passage at similar detail using original wording.

MODULE III — CONCEPT AND NATURE OF COMMUNICATION

Communication is the process of creating and exchanging meaning. It may be spoken, written, visual or non-verbal and can occur formally or informally.

Stages of Communication

Ideation	Encoding	Transmission	Decoding	Response
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The sender develops an idea, encodes it, transmits it through a channel, the receiver decodes it, and response/feedback completes the interaction.

Channels of Communication

Channel	Direction	Example
Downward	Higher → lower	Manager gives instructions
Upward	Lower → higher	Employee submits report
Horizontal	Peer ↔ peer	Team members coordinate
Diagonal	Across levels/functions	Cross-department coordination

Organizational Communication

- Internal communication occurs within an organization among employees, teams, managers and departments.
- External communication connects the organization with customers, suppliers, regulators, media and other stakeholders.

Barriers to Effective Communication

- Physical: noise, distance or poor connectivity.
- Semantic: ambiguity or unfamiliar words.
- Psychological: stress, fear, assumptions or inattention.
- Organizational: hierarchy, unclear roles or overload.
- Cultural: different norms and expectations.

Guidelines to Overcome Barriers

- Use simple and precise language.
- Choose an appropriate channel.
- Listen actively and invite feedback.
- Check understanding through questions or summaries.
- Respect cultural and individual differences.

The Listening Process

Receive	Attend	Interpret	Evaluate	Respond	Remember
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Listening with a Purpose

Purposes include obtaining information, solving a problem, evaluating an argument, learning a procedure or supporting another person.

Barriers to Listening

- Noise and distractions.
- Prejudice or premature judgment.
- Information overload.
- Emotional stress.
- Poor attention or multitasking.

Effective Listening Strategies

- Maintain attention.
- Ask relevant questions.
- Paraphrase key points.
- Notice tone and non-verbal cues.
- Take brief notes when appropriate.

Non-verbal Communication

Non-verbal communication conveys meaning without relying solely on words. Functions include reinforcing speech, replacing words, regulating interaction, showing emotion and managing impressions.

Gesture Cluster & Acoustic Features

A gesture cluster is a group of non-verbal signals interpreted together. Acoustic features include pitch, volume, rate, pauses, stress and intonation.

Q. What is feedback?

Answer: The receiver's response that helps the sender know whether the message was understood and how it was received.

MODULE IV — EFFECTIVE PRESENTATION

An effective presentation combines content, structure, visual support, voice, body language and audience interaction.

Pre-Presentation Jitters

Nervousness is common. Reduce it by knowing the material, rehearsing aloud, arriving early, checking equipment and using controlled breathing.

Preparation and Practice

Audience	Objective	Outline	Visuals	Rehearse	Revise
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Delivering the Presentation

Use a relevant opening, explain ideas logically, use examples and end with a clear takeaway. Maintain eye contact and speak at a controlled pace.

Qualities of a Skillful Presenter

- Clear organization and accurate content.
- Confident posture and purposeful eye contact.
- Audible voice, suitable pace and varied emphasis.
- Ability to read audience reactions.
- Professional appearance and time management.

Capturing and Maintaining Attention

Use a strong opening, questions, examples, short stories, relevant visuals and changes in pace. Avoid overcrowded slides and reading every word.

Handling Questions

- Listen to the entire question.
- Pause briefly before answering.
- Answer directly and honestly.
- If unsure, say so and offer to verify.
- Repeat a complex question when necessary.

PowerPoint Presentation

Good slides support the speaker. Use one clear idea per slide, readable typography, meaningful diagrams, consistent spacing and minimal text.

Netiquette

Netiquette means respectful and responsible online communication: informative subject lines, professional language, suitable tone, careful file sharing and responsible digital behaviour.

Professional Profiles & Blogs

A professional profile should accurately communicate education, skills, projects and interests. A blog should have a clear audience, useful headings and responsible sourcing.

Letters, Emails, Memo & Notices

Email: Recipient → Subject → Greeting → Purpose → Details → Action/Closing → Signature.

Memo: To → From → Date → Subject → Message → Action required.

Notice: Organization → NOTICE → Date → Title → Essential details → Authority/Signature.

Formal letter: Sender → Date → Recipient → Subject → Salutation → Body → Close → Signature.

MODULE V — EMPLOYMENT COMMUNICATION

Employment communication focuses on professional documents, reports and group interactions used to obtain and perform work.

Functions of a Report

- Record facts and findings.
- Analyze a situation.
- Support decisions.
- Recommend actions.
- Provide a documented reference.

Types of Report

Type	Purpose
Informational	Presents facts/findings.
Analytical	Examines evidence and draws conclusions.
Recommendation	Evaluates options and proposes action.
Formal/Informal	Different structure and detail based on purpose.

The Report/Proposal Process

Define	Research	Analyze	Outline	Draft	Review	Submit
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Organizing the Report/Proposal

- Introduction: purpose, scope and background.
- Main discussion/findings.
- Analysis and conclusions.
- Recommendations where required.
- References and appendices where appropriate.

Resume Writing

A resume is a concise professional document tailored to a role. Typical sections include contact details, profile/objective, education, skills, projects, experience/internships, achievements and relevant certifications.

Resume Checklist

- Keep formatting consistent and easy to scan.
- Use action-oriented language.
- Prioritize relevant skills and projects.
- Avoid spelling errors and unsupported claims.
- Tailor the resume to the position.

Group Discussion

A GD is a structured discussion used to assess communication, reasoning, teamwork and leadership-related behaviours.

Qualities/Skills Assessed

- Clarity of thought and speech.
- Listening and responsiveness.
- Reasoning and relevant examples.
- Respect for other viewpoints.
- Team orientation and constructive leadership.
- Ability to summarize or move discussion forward.

Do's and Don'ts in GD

Do	Don't
Listen and build on useful points.	Interrupt repeatedly.
Use evidence/examples.	Make personal attacks.
Invite quieter members to contribute.	Dominate the discussion.
Disagree respectfully.	Change topic without reason.

Effective Participation in GD

Understand	Listen	Contribute	Respond	Encourage	Summarize
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Mock GD Topics

Practice: Is AI a threat or an opportunity for students? Should college attendance be fully online? Does social media improve communication? Prepare a 60-second opening, two relevant points, one response and a concise conclusion.

EXAM KIT — QUICK REVISION

Important Questions

Q. Explain the stages of communication with a suitable flow diagram.

Answer: Communication moves from ideation through encoding and transmission to decoding and response/feedback.

Q. Differentiate downward, upward, horizontal and diagonal communication.

Answer: They describe information flow from higher to lower, lower to higher, peer to peer and across levels/functions.

Q. Explain barriers to effective communication and ways to overcome them.

Answer: Barriers may be physical, semantic, psychological, organizational or cultural. Clear language, suitable channels, active listening and feedback reduce them.

Q. What are effective listening strategies?

Answer: Attend carefully, avoid premature judgment, ask questions, paraphrase key ideas, observe non-verbal cues and confirm understanding.

Q. Explain the essentials of an effective presentation.

Answer: Set an objective, understand the audience, structure content, prepare visuals, rehearse, deliver clearly, manage questions and close with a takeaway.

Q. What is netiquette?

Answer: It is respectful and responsible practice for online communication.

Q. Explain the report/proposal process.

Answer: Define purpose, research, analyze information, outline, draft, review and submit.

Q. What skills are assessed in a group discussion?

Answer: Communication, reasoning, listening, teamwork, respectful disagreement, leadership and synthesis.

Revision Map

Grammar	Writing	Communication	Presentation	Employment
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Exam Strategy

- For definitions: meaning + example.
- For processes: draw a flowchart and explain stages.
- For differences: use a comparison table.
- For long answers: headings + short paragraphs + examples.
- For formats: remember component order.
- Practice at least one written answer from each module.

References supplied in the syllabus: K. K. Sinha; Lesikar and Pettit; John Adair; B. Elizabeth Pryse.